

Yuan Xiao (Joel)

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Game & Visual Designer

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Blending creativity with technology, I craft intuitive user experiences and immersive 3D environments that balance clarity, aesthetics, and usability. Guided by a meticulous eye for detail and a user-centered mindset, I turn concepts into visually compelling and highly engaging digital experiences.

<https://onesoilY.github.io/yuan/>

SKILLS

Development & Programming

- JavaScript
- React
- HTML & CSS
- Unity

Visual Design

- After Effects
- Illustrator
- Photoshop
- Figma
- Maya

EDUCATION

Simon Fraser University 09/2021 – present
Bachelor of Science in Interactive Arts & Technology | Cumulative GPA: 3.47

PROJECT EXPERIENCES

VR Developer & 3D Modeler, *Beyond the Horizon* – VR Game 01/2025 – 04/2025

- Focused on front-end and visual design, developed interactive UI and environments in Unity to ensure an intuitive and immersive player experience from the start.
- Created high-fidelity 3D environments and assets, independently modeled and textured key elements such as the bedroom, photographs, swim tube, and mirror, enhancing narrative depth and atmospheric storytelling.
- Implemented core interactions and functionality, wrote C# scripts to handle VR physics-based collision detection, object interactions, and memory-triggering mechanics, continuously optimizing performance for a seamless experience.
- Enhanced player immersion, coordinated lighting, sound design, and cinematic transitions to create a smooth emotional progression from despair to healing and hope.

3D Modeler and Animator, *Set Sail Again* – Short Film 09/2024 – 12/2024

- Led the 3D modeling process and utilized Maya to create optimized topology, clean mesh structures, and perform texture and weight painting for both characters and environments, ensuring smooth animation and rendering.
- Applied keyframing and physics-based motion simulations to refine character movement and environmental interactions, strengthening visual storytelling.
- Used Arnold for realistic lighting setup and material adjustments, followed by color correction and editing in Premiere Pro for a cohesive visual style.
- Iteratively tested shot compositions, scene layouts, and character animations to maintain narrative coherence and technical precision.

Game Designer & Narrative Lead, *Escape* – Board Game 10/2024 – 12/2024

- Adapted an original post-apocalyptic script into a strategic board game with hidden roles, phased gameplay, and narrative-driven event cards to recreate the story's tension and emotional stakes.
- Designed and wrote 40+ event and character cards, embedding each with gameplay mechanics and narrative depth, while balancing effects through continuous playtesting.
- Developed level mechanics for the game map, including player movement, campsite interactions, and FEAR pursuit rules, ensuring high-stakes decision-making throughout.
- Structured and laid out the instruction book for clarity and accessibility, integrating complex systems like bonfire voting, nightfall risk, and role-based actions.

Web Developer, SFU Climate Community Interactive Website 02/2024 – 04/2024

- Built a multi-page responsive website using semantic HTML structure and advanced CSS techniques such as media queries and animations.
- Carefully designed typography and color contrast to ensure a consistent and user-friendly experience across different devices and browsers.
- Iterative user testing and refinement, regularly gathered user feedback, adjusted page layouts, and optimized visual hierarchy to improve usability and interaction.
- Designed content and structure in alignment with community outreach goals, ensuring the website effectively conveyed climate-related messages.